tion, then the healthcare provider will have to rely on the family members/caregivers to provide said information. What about the emergency drugs, if any, needed for such patients? There is no real medium to confirm the source of the drugs procured or to track the delivery of the drugs from its point of origin to the hospital drug store.

If blockchain technologies are applied to the healthcare industry, service providers might potentially be looking at a method of having accurate information about their patients. This is just the tip of the iceberg. There is so much more that can happen if blockchain and the entire healthcare industry join hands.

While critics of blockchain will point out that as a technology it is difficult to adopt and put into use, the truth is that it can exponentially change the face of the healthcare industry in more than one way. Here's how:

EHR or Electronic Health Records

Let's revisit the example we began with. When a patient is admitted into a hospital, they are asked about their current and past medical history. Forms are filled at the counter at the entrance. Then the patient is taken in for testing, where a medical officer will ask similar questions yet again. Finally, once the patient lands up in a ward/bed, the doctor on duty is bound to ask questions that sounds irritatingly similar to the questions asked and already answered multiple times in the same day.

Truth being said, the hospital staff does this questioning and re-questioning because it is their policy and is part of the protocol. But it became part of the protocol for one simple reason - they had to be sure about the information they were taking down and they simply didn't trust their current method of information gathering. EHR or Electronic Health Records, which is currently the favoured method of collecting patient records and data, is not effective when it comes to multiple institutions. In reality, patients end up leaving scattered medical records over multiple hospitals and healthcare centers over the years.

With blockchain technology, the medical records of a patient (both current and historic) are owned by the patient and can be shared with medical care practitioners by using a public key that the patient can share with the hospital upon their arrival. Blockchain can help streamline the patient data and make it accessible to the patient as well as health care providers.

Given that blockchain is based on the premise that it is immutable, the trust factor is also higher than for the current system. Doctors should be